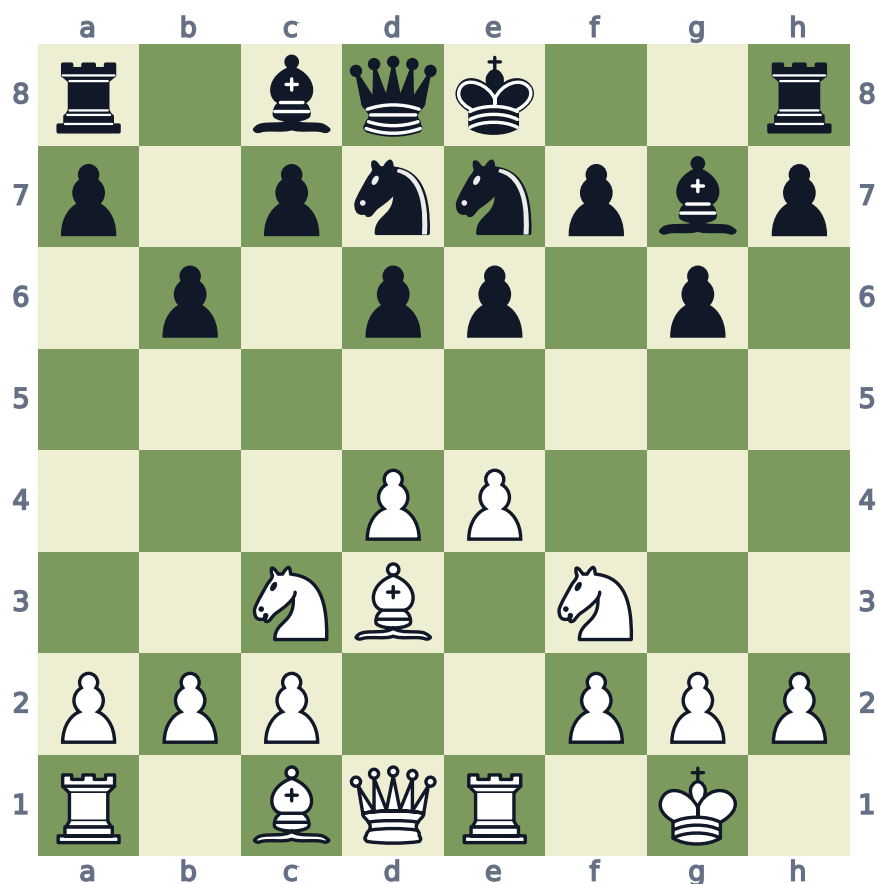


Hippo Foundations and Setup Map

The compact shell, move-order logic, break compass, and limits of the system



Build the Hippopotamus position from understanding, recognize when the shell is safe, and know which central or wing break should transform it.

12 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Build the Hippopotamus position from understanding, recognize when the shell is safe, and know which central or wing break should transform it.

THE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- First identify the center, both kings, and the opponent's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram, name the urgent threat and compare e5, c5, f5, and b5.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, its purpose, and the opponent's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 12 units inside a connected Black core repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the PGN companions make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

The Hippo is a flexible family of positions, not eight automatic moves.

PRINCIPLE 2

Black concedes space so White's center can become a target, but space is dangerous until challenged.

PRINCIPLE 3

The usual shell uses g6, Bg7, d6, e6, Ne7, Nd7, b6, and Bb7 in an order chosen by threats.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

Castling is common, but the king's safest square depends on how quickly White opens files.

PRINCIPLE 5

Every quiet move must preserve at least one useful break: e5, c5, f5, or b5.

PRINCIPLE 6

If the opponent can attack before a break is ready, abandon the shell and solve the concrete problem.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|-------------------------------------|--|
| 01 | Core shell against e4 and d4 | The shell is a launch platform; scan for White's break before adding the last piece. |
| 02 | Austrian-style center map | f4 makes e4 stronger and the king looser; choose the break from concrete support. |
| 03 | Early h-pawn map | When h4 appears, king safety becomes a move-order question. |
| 04 | Classical d4-c4-e4 shell | Against three central pawns, identify the base before selecting the break. |
| 05 | Fianchetto center map | Matching fianchettos make the center, not the bishops, the first decision. |
| 06 | English transposition map | Flank openings become Hippos only after the center tells you they should. |
| 07 | Reti transposition map | Do not answer quietness with aimlessness; prepare a break while transposing. |
| 08 | Bird center map | The first move changes tempo, not the structural questions. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 9-12

09 e5 break compass

Play e5 when contact activates pieces and the resulting d5 square is manageable.

10 c5 break compass

c5 is a question to the base of the center, not a decorative pawn move.

11 f5 break compass

Count e4 support and king lines before touching the f-pawn.

12 b5 break compass

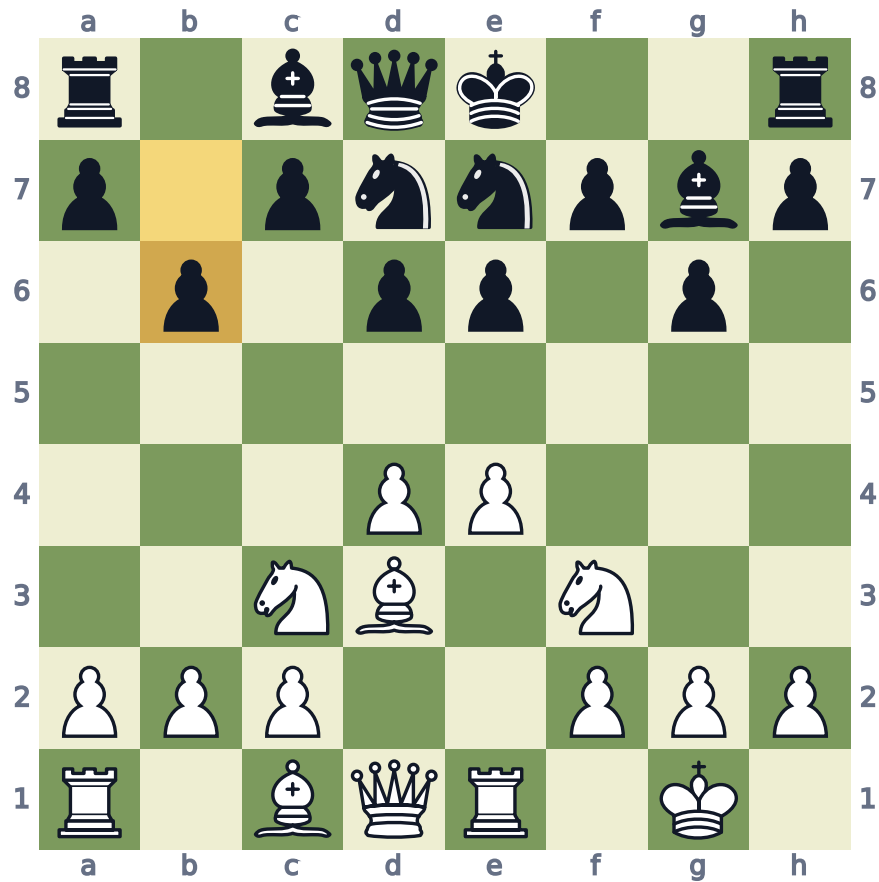
b5 works when the center is stable and the rook or queen can use opened files.

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

Core shell against e4 and d4



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. Nf3 e6 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7 7. Re1 b6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

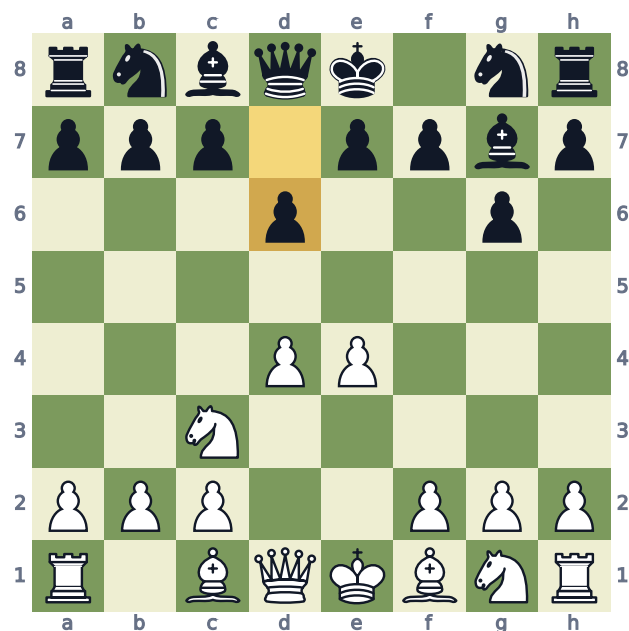
Complete the compact shell while keeping all four breaks available.

MAIN DANGER

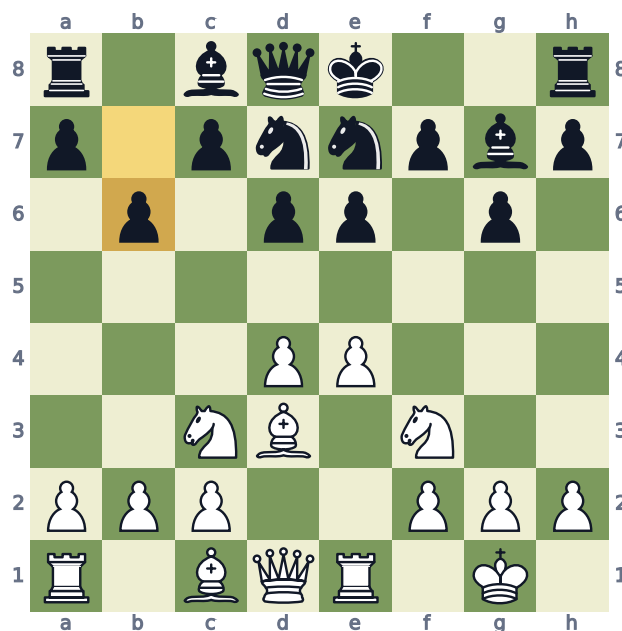
White may use e5 or h4 before Bb7 is useful.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The shell is a launch platform; scan for White's break before adding the last piece.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.94 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bf4 O-O 2. Qd2 Bb7 3. Rad1 a6 4. h4 e5 5. Bh6 exd4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

Core shell against e4 and d4



YOUR TASK

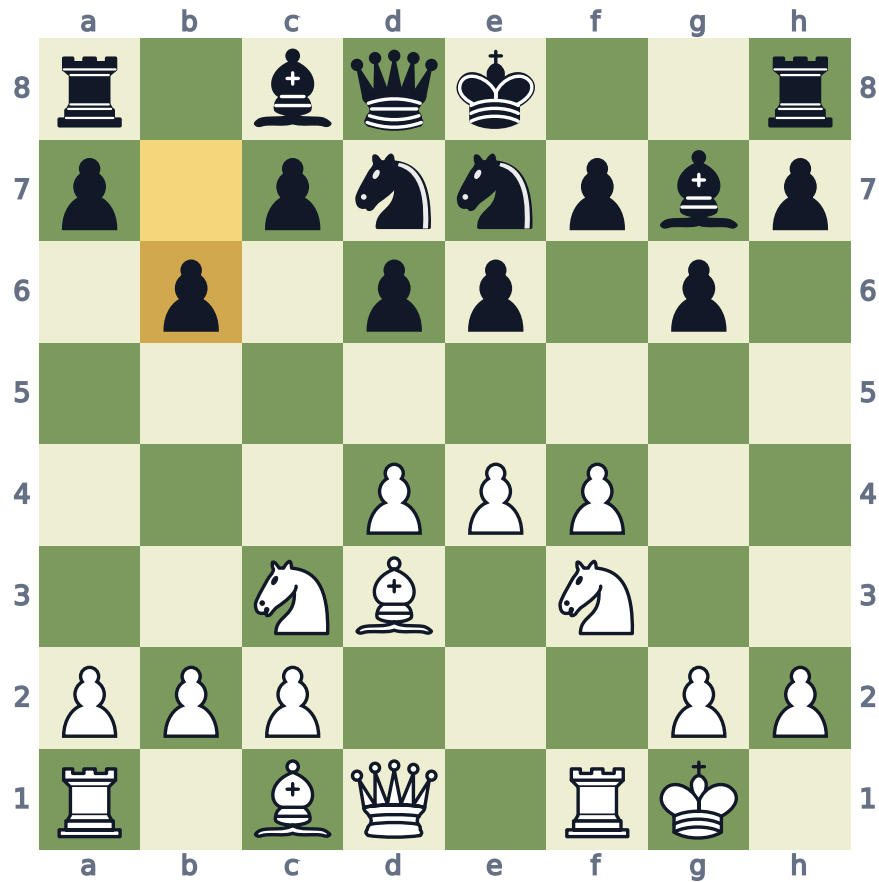
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

Austrian-style center map



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Bd3 Nd7 7. O-O b6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

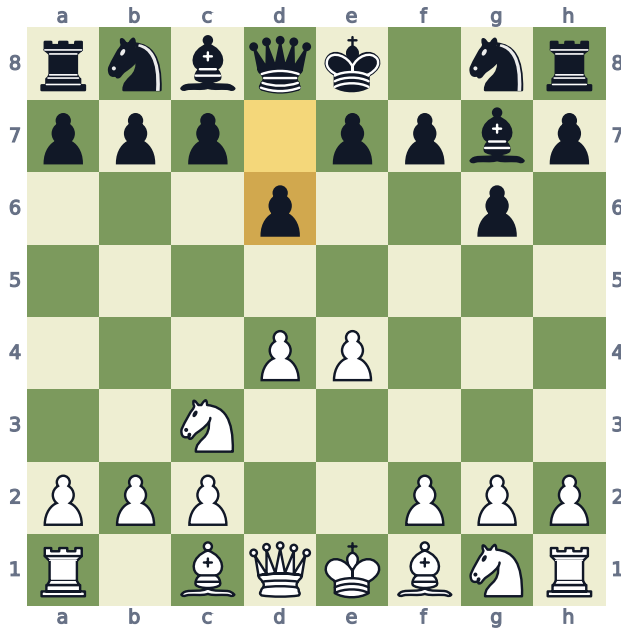
Restrain the center and prepare a challenge to e4 or d4.

MAIN DANGER

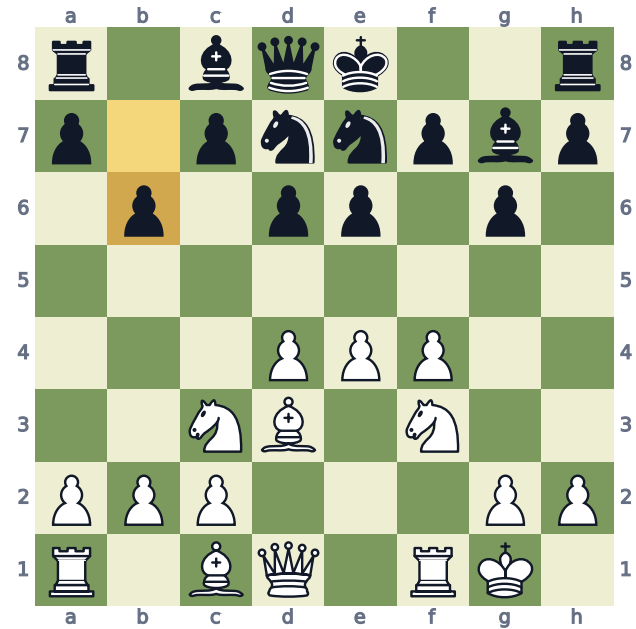
White's f5 or e5 can arrive with tempo.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

f4 makes e4 stronger and the king looser; choose the break from concrete support.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

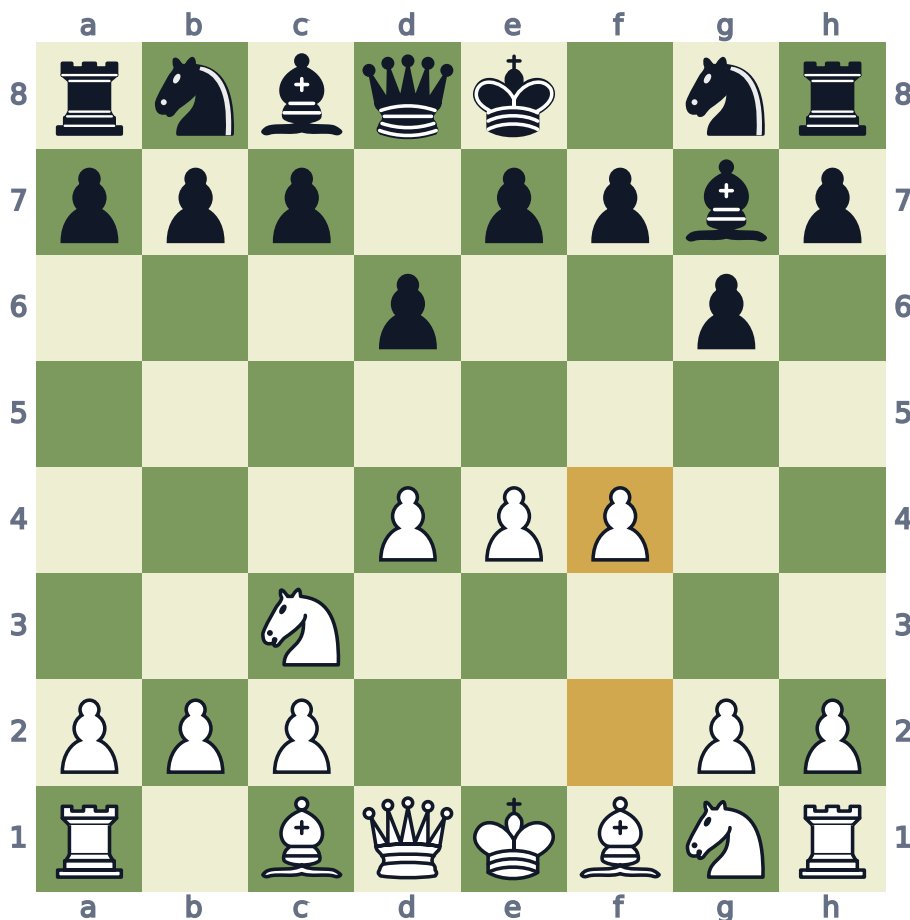
Position estimate: +1.40 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. f5 exf5 2. exf5 Nf6 3. fxg6 hxg6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

Austrian-style center map



YOUR TASK

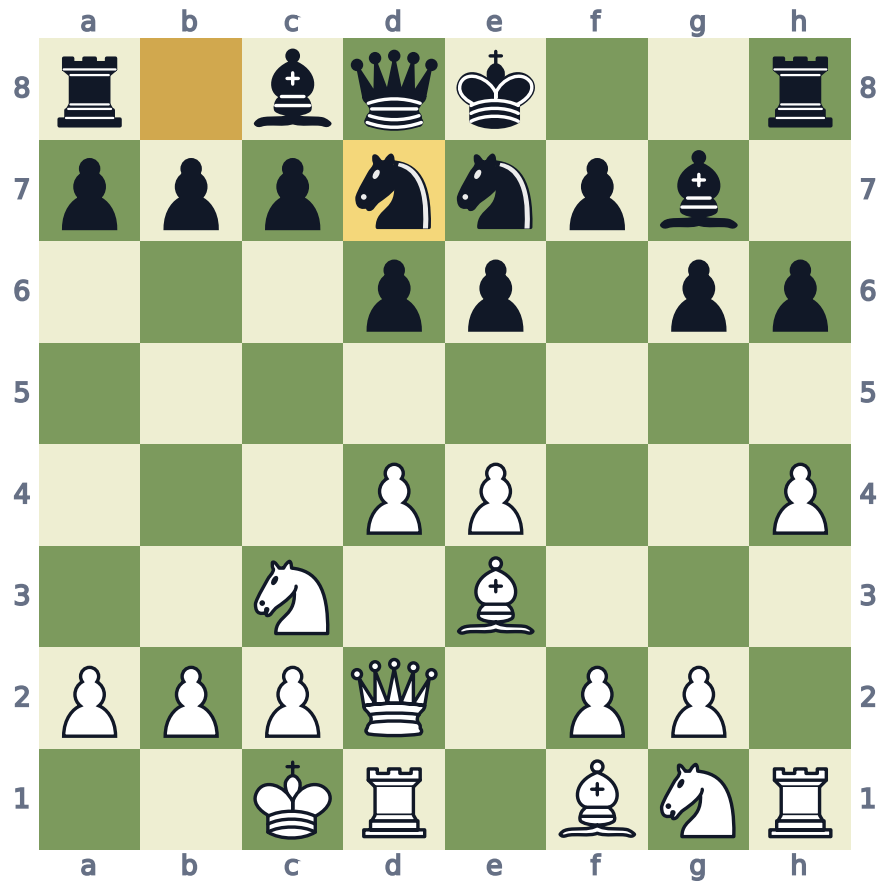
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

Early h-pawn map



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. h4 h6 5. Be3 e6 6. Qd2 Ne7 7. O-O-O Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Slow the h-pawn, keep the king flexible, and seek queenside counterplay.

MAIN DANGER

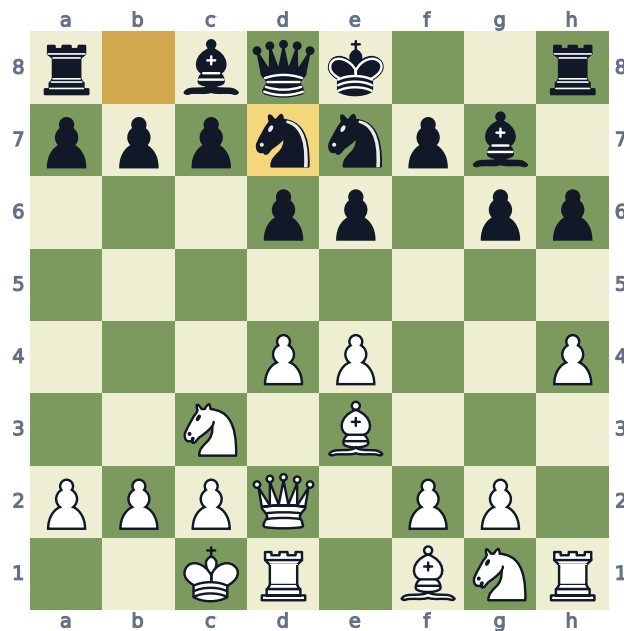
Automatic castling can place the king on the wing White already attacks.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When h4 appears, king safety becomes a move-order question.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.40 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 g5 2. f4 g4 3. Bd3 f5 4. Nge2 O-O 5. d5 exd5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

Early h-pawn map



YOUR TASK

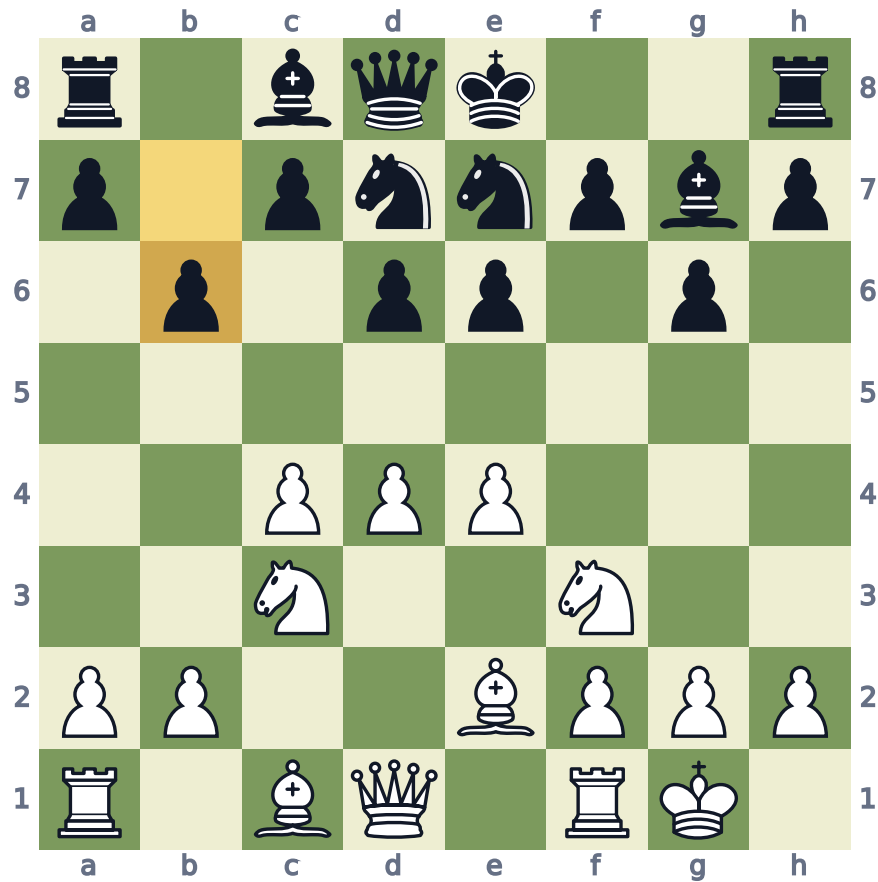
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Classical d4-c4-e4 shell



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Be2 Nd7 7. O-O b6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Build against the broad center and compare e5 with c5.

MAIN DANGER

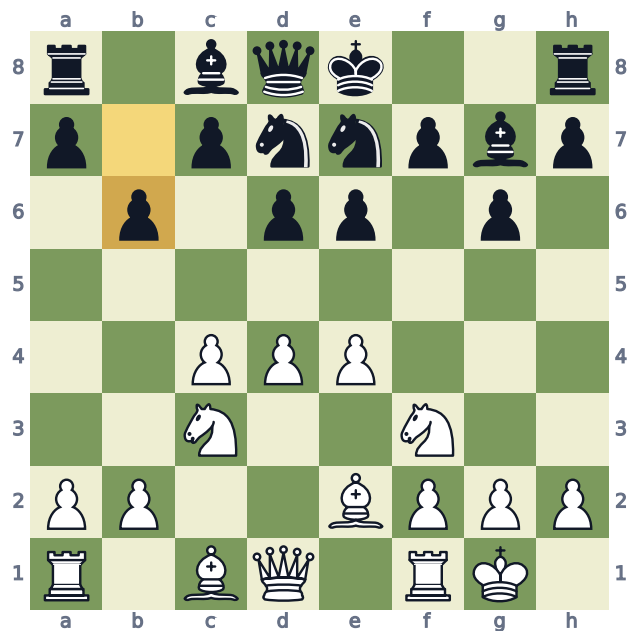
White may gain more space with d5 before Black acts.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against three central pawns, identify the base before selecting the break.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

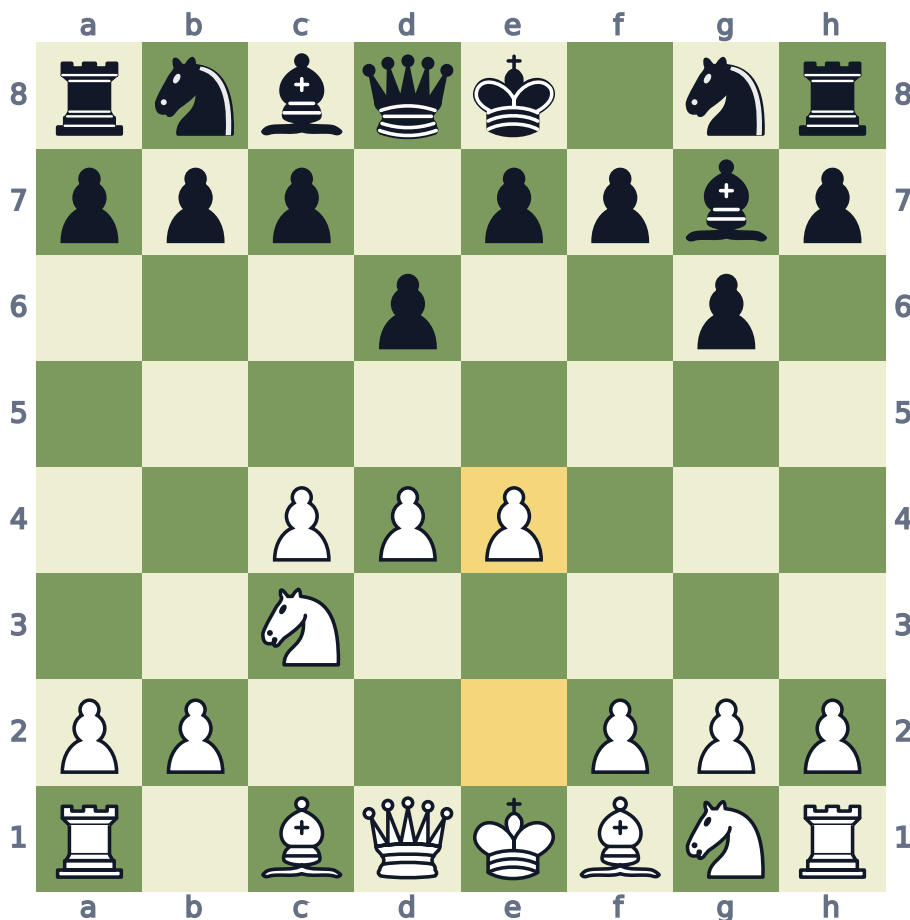
Position estimate: +0.97 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Be3 O-O 2. Qd2 Nf6 3. Bh6 Bb7 4. d5 e5 5. b4 a5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Classical d4-c4-e4 shell



YOUR TASK

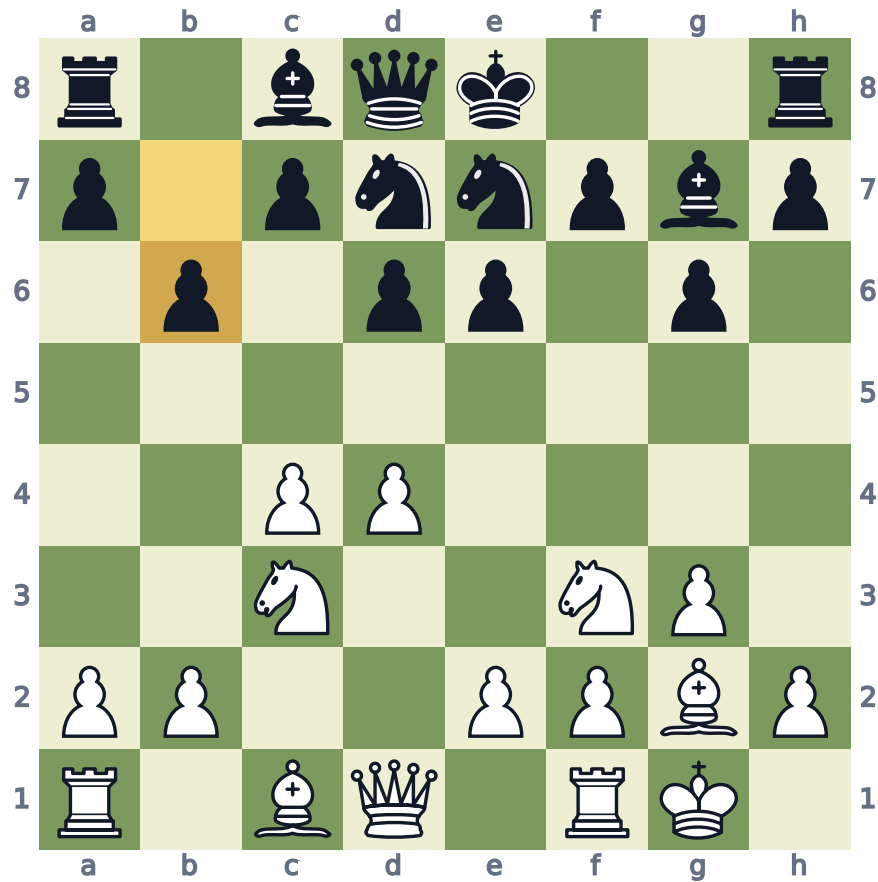
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Fianchetto center map



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. Nf3 Bg7 3. g3 d6 4. Bg2 e6 5. O-O Ne7 6. c4 Nd7 7. Nc3 b6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Keep a compact position while preparing Bb7 and central contact.

MAIN DANGER

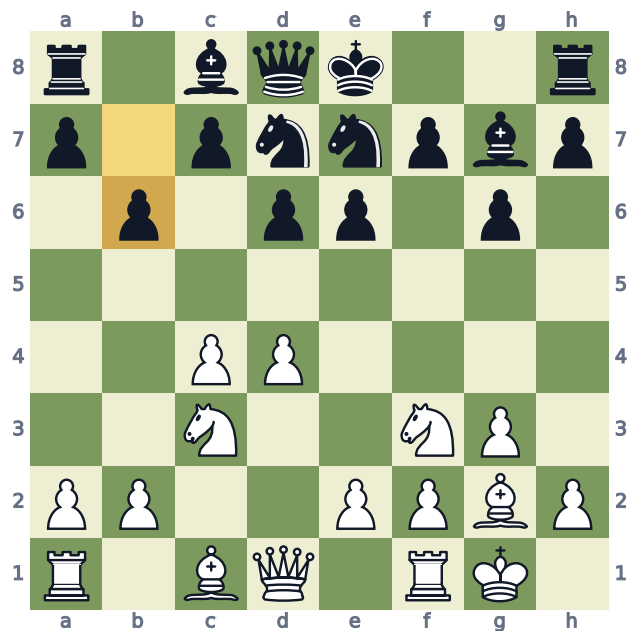
White's long diagonal can punish careless queenside expansion.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Matching fianchettos make the center, not the bishops, the first decision.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

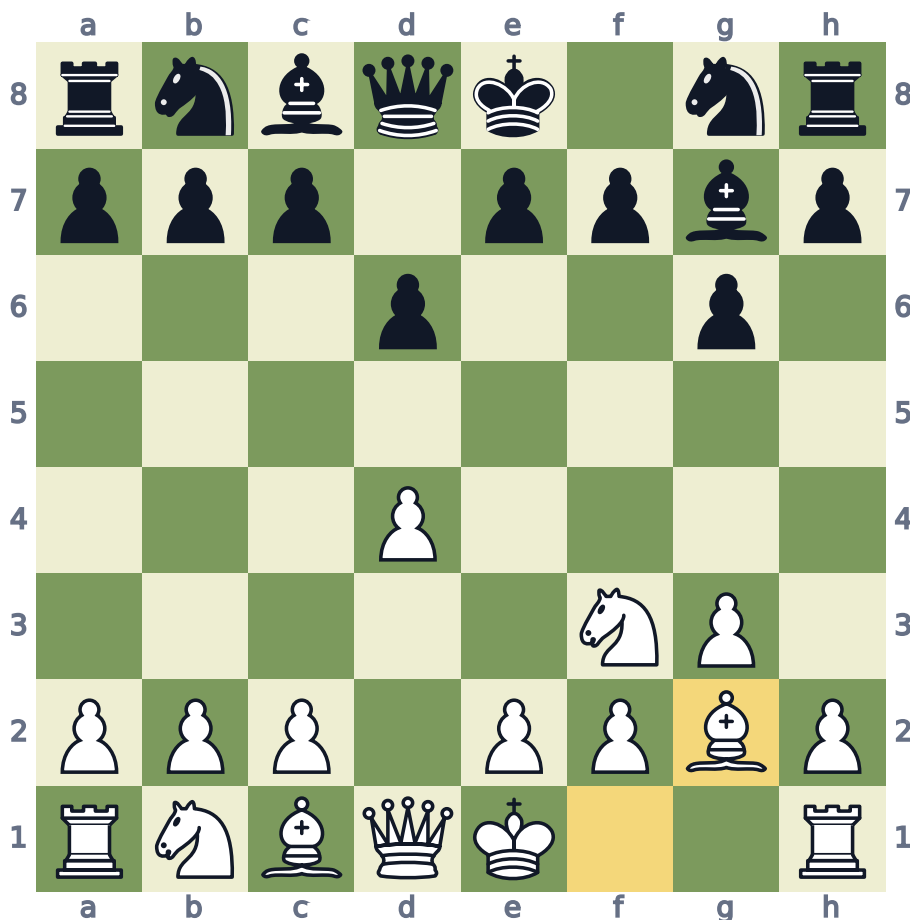
Position estimate: +0.93 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. e4 O-O 2. Be3 a6 3. Re1 Rb8 4. Rc1 c5 5. dxc5 Nxc5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Fianchetto center map



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

English transposition map



COURSE LINE

1. c4 g6 2. Nc3 Bg7 3. g3 d6 4. Bg2 e6 5. d3 Ne7 6. e4 Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Reach a Hippo structure after White claims e4 later.

MAIN DANGER

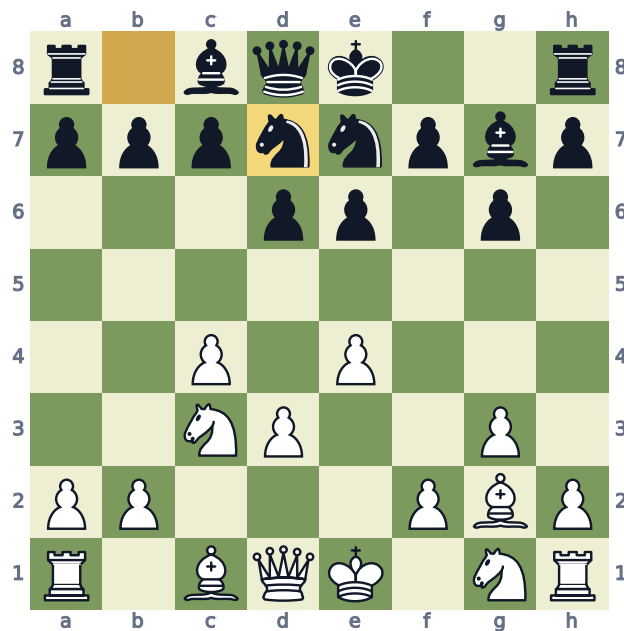
White can use d4 in one move if Black waits too long.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Flank openings become Hippos only after the center tells you they should.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

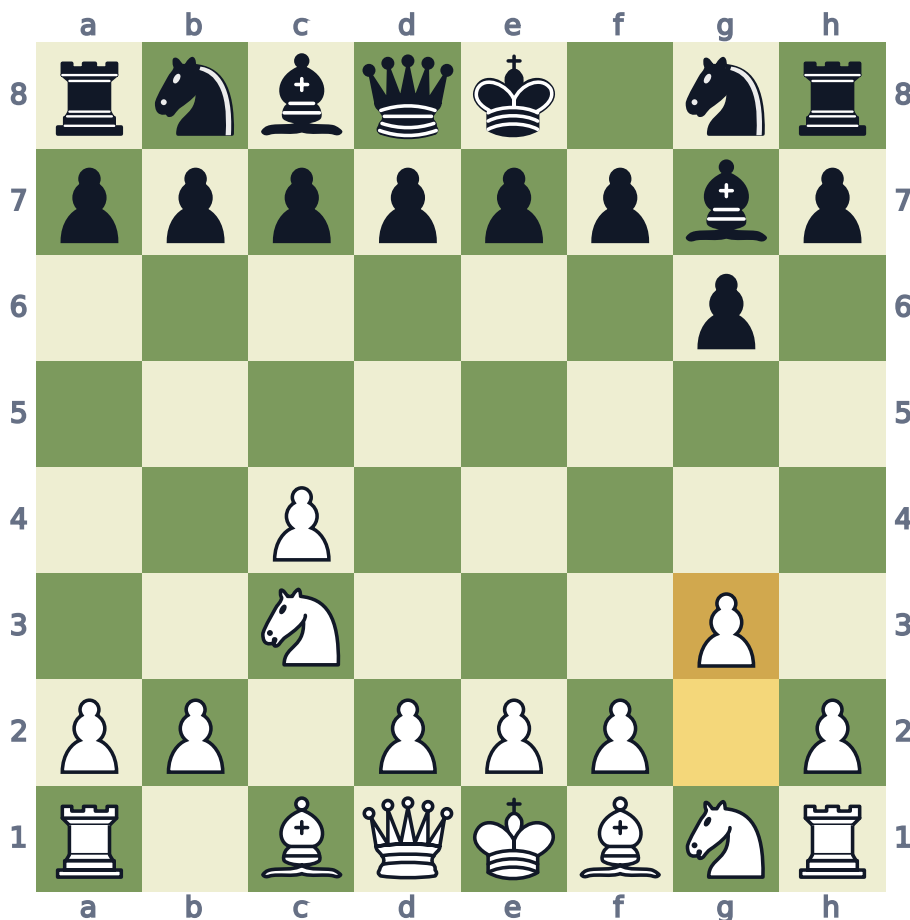
Position estimate: +0.54 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. d4 c5 2. Nge2 Nc6 3. Be3 cxd4 4. Nxd4 Nde5 5. b3 Ng4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

English transposition map



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Reti transposition map



COURSE LINE

1. Nf3 g6 2. g3 Bg7 3. Bg2 d6 4. O-O e6 5. d3 Ne7 6. e4 Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

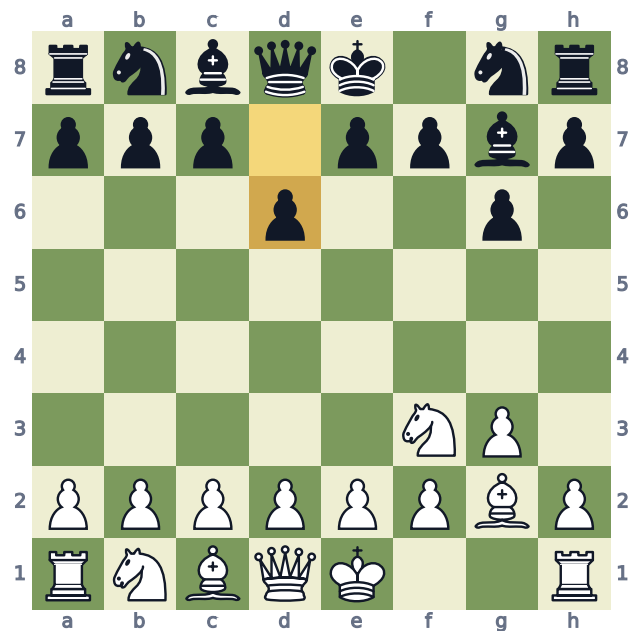
Preserve flexibility until White declares the center.

MAIN DANGER

A quiet White setup can still seize d4 and c4 efficiently.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Do not answer quietness with aimlessness; prepare a break while transposing.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

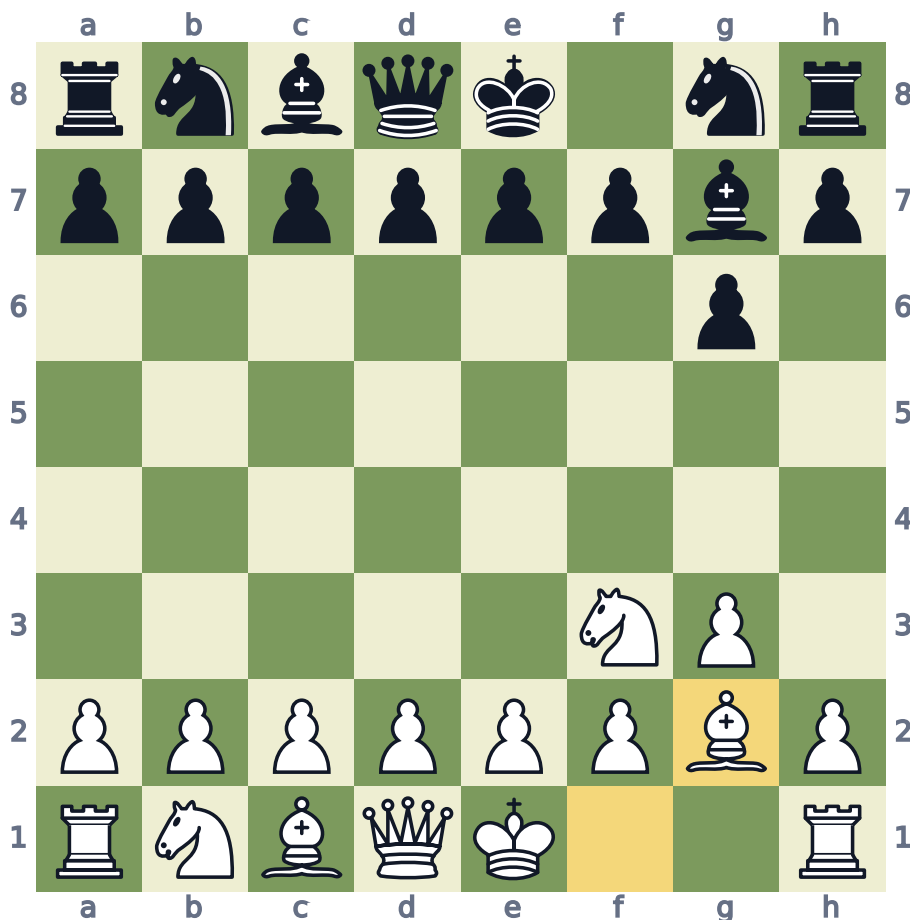
Position estimate: +0.48 for White (White is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a4 e5 2. Nc3 a6 3. Be3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Reti transposition map



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Bird center map



COURSE LINE

1. f4 g6 2. Nf3 Bg7 3. e4 d6 4. d4 e6 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

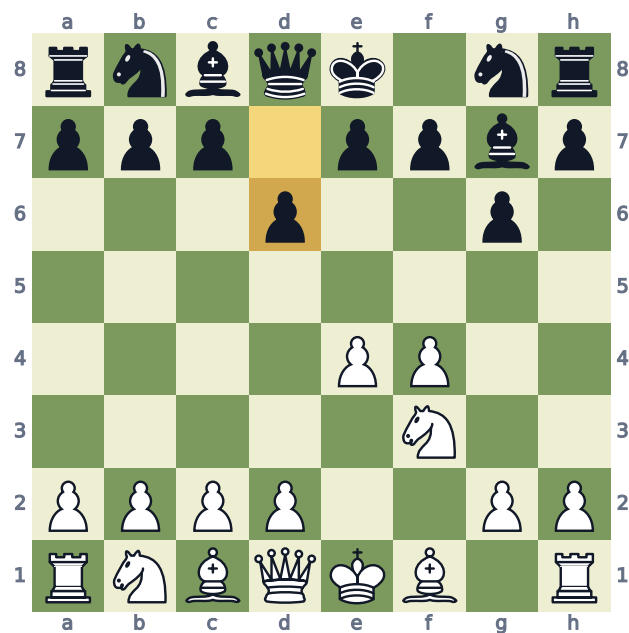
Treat the position as a reversed Austrian center and target e4.

MAIN DANGER

White's extra tempo can make f5 fast.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

The first move changes tempo, not the structural questions.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.97 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. c4 O-O 2. Nc3 f5 3. e5 dxe5 4. dxe5 Nc5 5. Bc2 Nc6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Bird center map



YOUR TASK

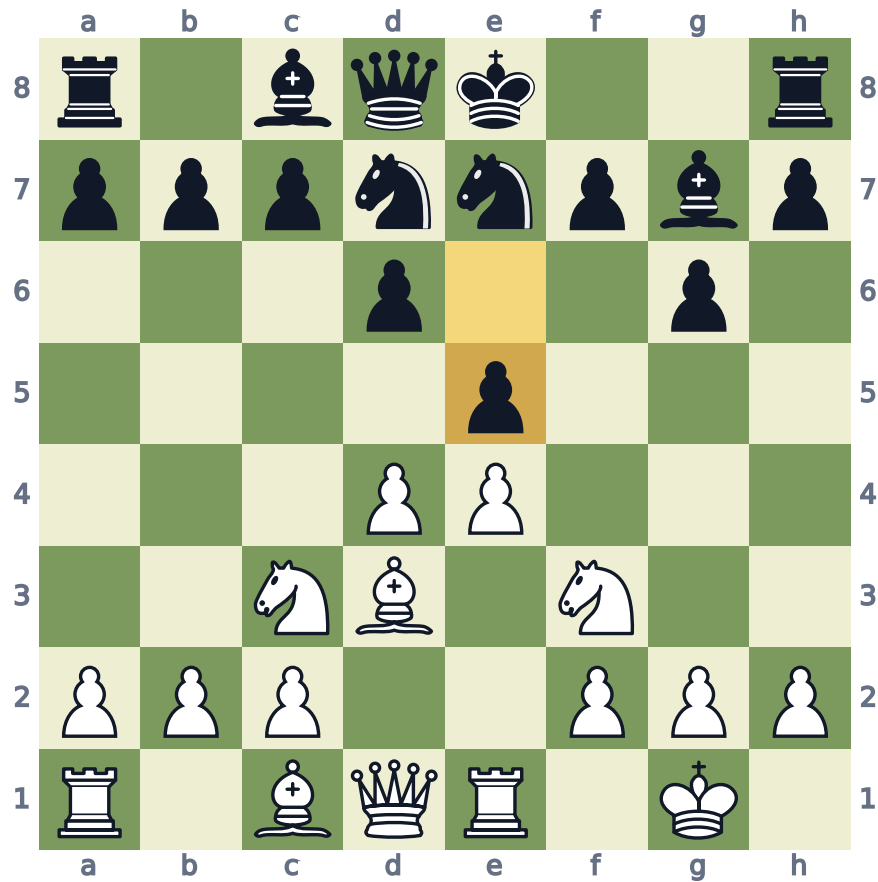
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 09

e5 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. Nf3 e5 5. Bd3 Ne7 6. O-O Nd7 7. Re1 e5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

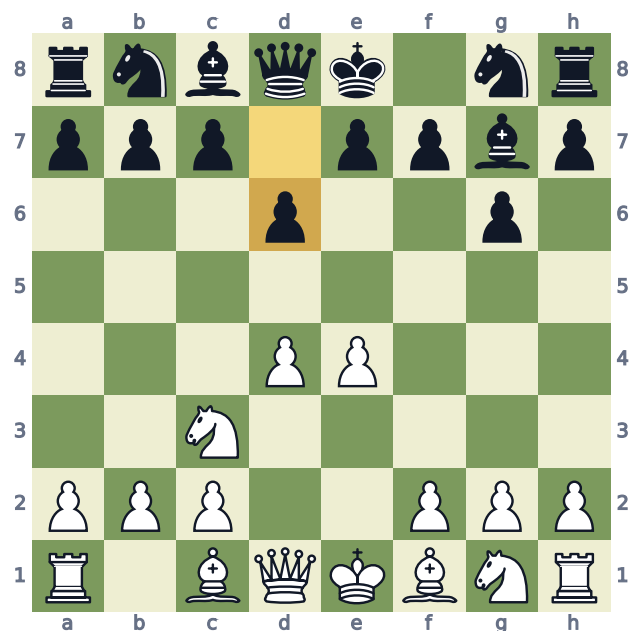
Challenge d4 and open routes for the compact pieces.

MAIN DANGER

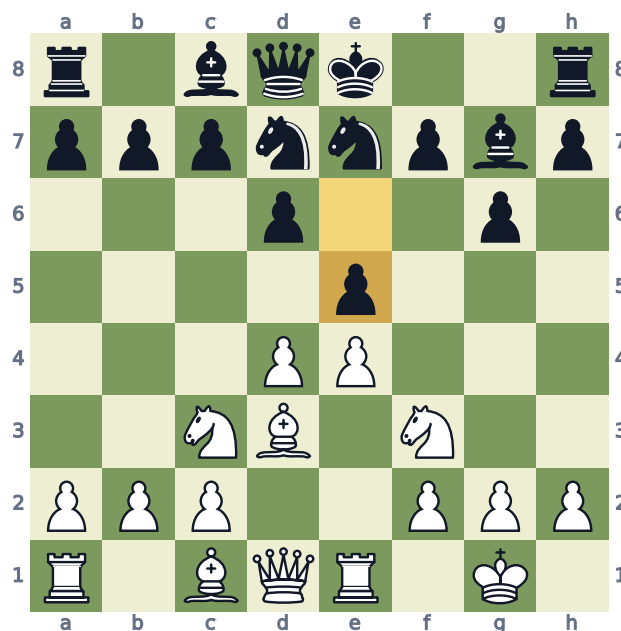
The break can leave d5 weak or meet d5 with less space.

BRANCH LOGIC 09

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Play e5 when contact activates pieces and the resulting d5 square is manageable.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +1.17 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. dxe5 Nxe5 2. Nxe5 dxe5 3. Bc4 Qxd1 4. Rxd1 c6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 09

e5 break compass



YOUR TASK

Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 10

c5 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Be2 Nd7 7. O-O c5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

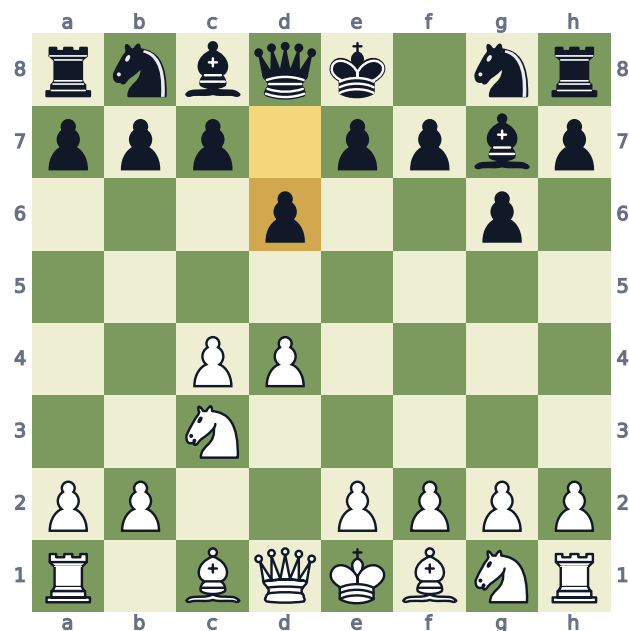
Attack d4 and create queenside files before White fixes the center.

MAIN DANGER

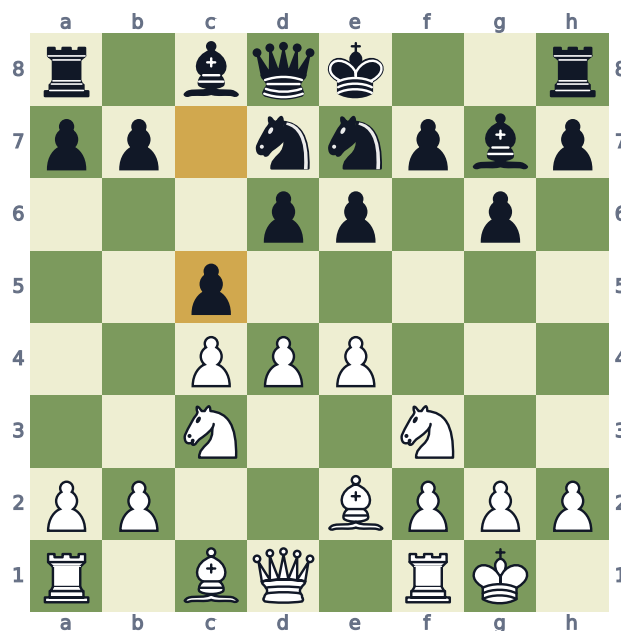
White can close with d5 and gain space.

BRANCH LOGIC 10

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

c5 is a question to the base of the center, not a decorative pawn move.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

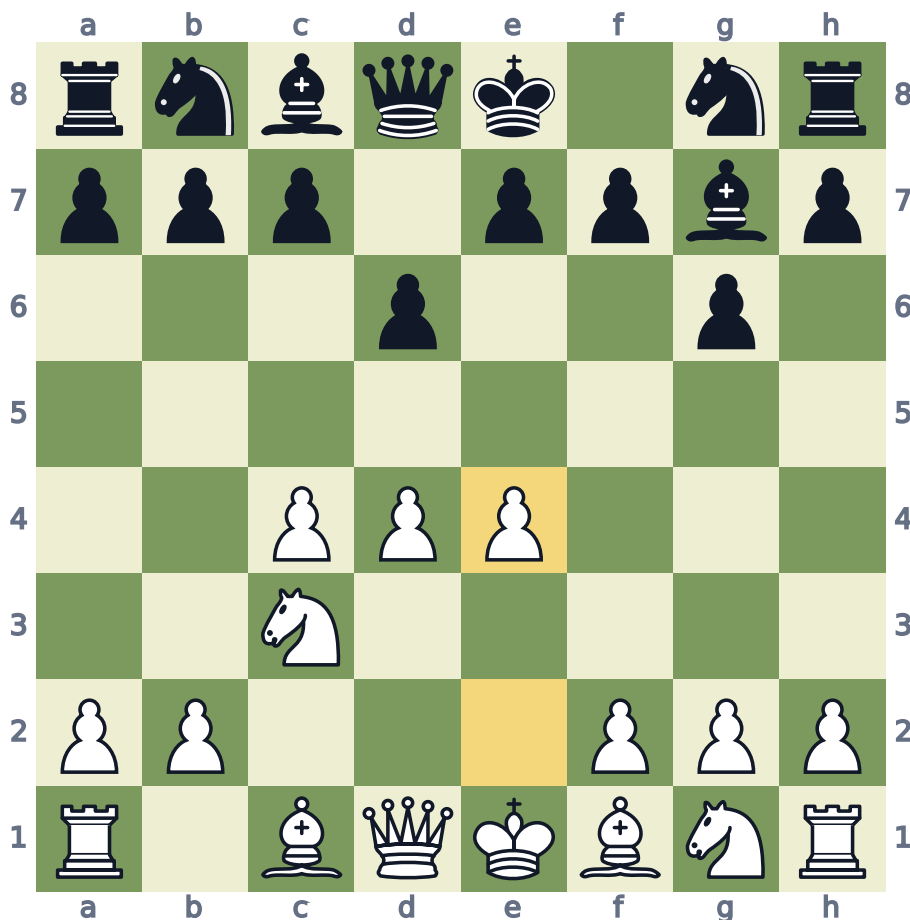
Position estimate: +1.60 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nb5 O-O 2. Nxd6 Qb6 3. dxc5 Nxc5 4. Rb1 a5 5. e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 10

c5 break compass



YOUR TASK

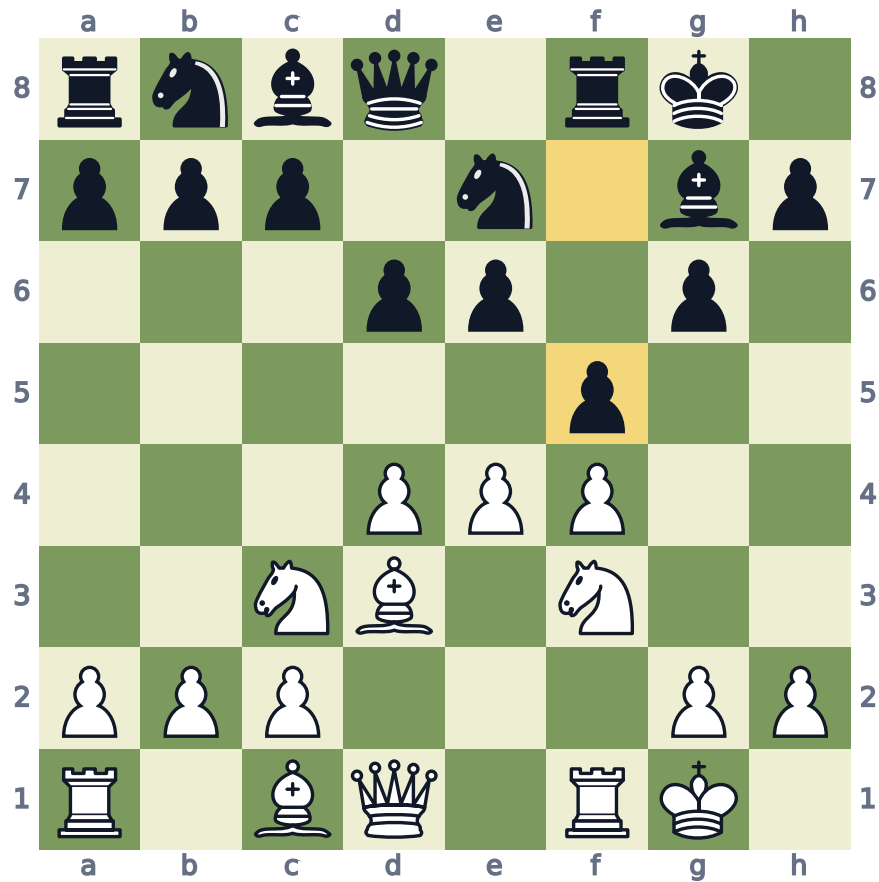
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 11

f5 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. e4 g6 2. d4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. f4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Bd3 O-O 7. O-O f5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge e4 and create kingside activity after securing the king.

MAIN DANGER

Opening the f-file can expose Black as easily as White.

BRANCH LOGIC 11

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Count e4 support and king lines before touching the f-pawn.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +0.95 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. e5 a6 2. a4 Nbc6 3. Be3 Nb4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 11

f5 break compass



YOUR TASK

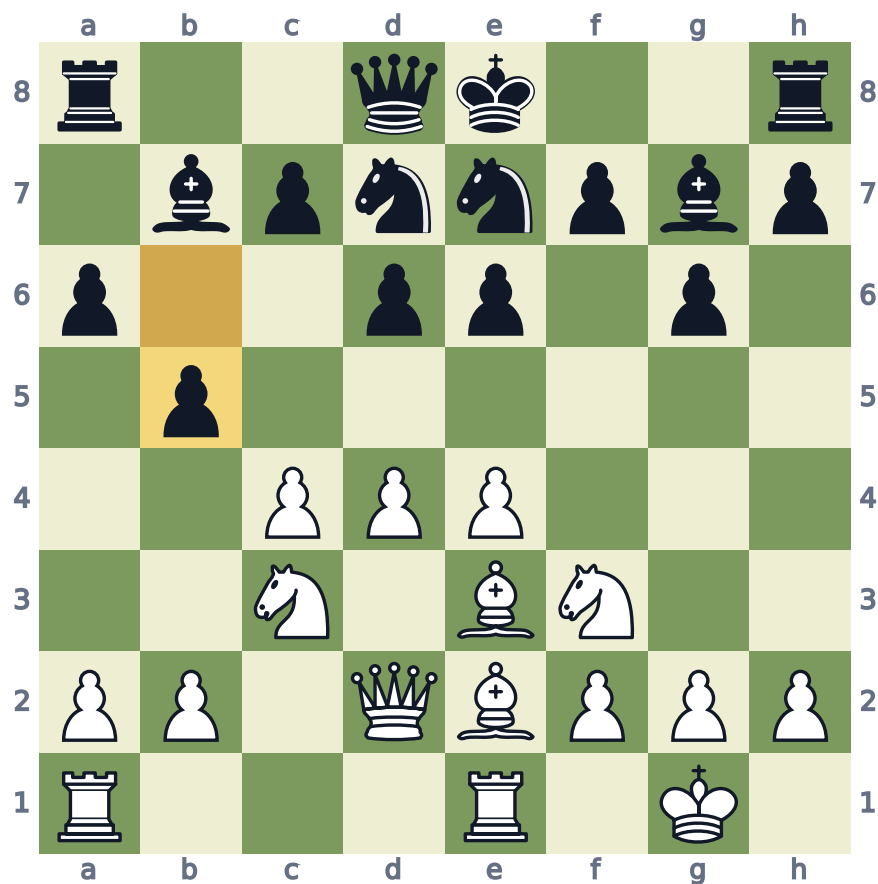
Black to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 12

b5 break compass



COURSE LINE

1. d4 g6 2. c4 Bg7 3. Nc3 d6 4. e4 e6 5. Nf3 Ne7 6. Be2 Nd7 7. O-O b6 8. Be3 Bb7 9. Qd2 a6 10. Rfe1 b5

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Gain queenside space and prepare b4 against a stable center.

MAIN DANGER

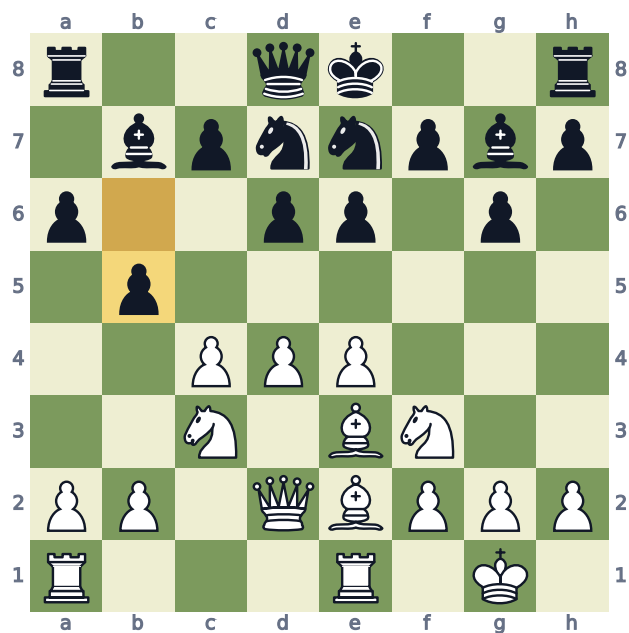
A central opening can make wing expansion irrelevant.

BRANCH LOGIC 12

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 10 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

b5 works when the center is stable and the rook or queen can use opened files.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: +2.13 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. cxb5 axb5 2. Bxb5 O-O 3. a4 Nf6 4. Bg5 d5 5. e5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

b5 break compass



SCORING

42

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. CORE SHELL AGAINST E4 AND D4

Course move: e6. Purpose: Complete the compact shell while keeping all four breaks available. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3 (+0.64 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White may use e5 or h4 before Bb7 is useful.

02. AUSTRIAN-STYLE CENTER MAP

Course move: e6. Purpose: Restrain the center and prepare a challenge to e4 or d4. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3 (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White's f5 or e5 can arrive with tempo.

03. EARLY H-PAWN MAP

Course move: h6. Purpose: Slow the h-pawn, keep the king flexible, and seek queenside counterplay. Engine comparison: 1. h5 Be3 2. c6 Qd2 3. b5 f3 4. a5 Bd3 5. Na6 (+0.53 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Automatic castling can place the king on the wing White already attacks.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. CLASSICAL D4-C4-E4 SHELL

Course move: e6. Purpose: Build against the broad center and compare e5 with c5. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. e5 d5 4. Na6 Qd2 5. Ng4 Bxg4 (+0.56 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White may gain more space with d5 before Black acts.

05. FIANCHETTO CENTER MAP

Course move: e6. Purpose: Keep a compact position while preparing Bb7 and central contact. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 c4 2. Nbd7 Nc3 3. O-O O-O 4. e5 Qc2 5. Re8 Be3 (+0.50 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White's long diagonal can punish careless queenside expansion.

06. ENGLISH TRANSPOSITION MAP

Course move: d6. Purpose: Reach a Hippo structure after White claims e4 later. Engine comparison: 1. e5 Nf3 2. Nc6 Bg2 3. Nge7 d3 4. O-O O-O 5. d6 Rb1 (+0.20 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White can use d4 in one move if Black waits too long.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-9

07. RETI TRANSPOSITION MAP

Course move: d6. Purpose: Preserve flexibility until White declares the center. Engine comparison: 1. d5 d4 2. Nf6 c4 3. dxc4 Qa4+ 4. c6 Qxc4 5. a5 O-O (+0.17 for White (equal)). Warning: A quiet White setup can still seize d4 and c4 efficiently.

08. BIRD CENTER MAP

Course move: d6. Purpose: Treat the position as a reversed Austrian center and target e4. Engine comparison: 1. c5 Nc3 2. Nc6 a4 3. a6 Bc4 4. e6 O-O (-0.04 for White (equal)). Warning: White's extra tempo can make f5 fast.

09. E5 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: e6. Purpose: Challenge d4 and open routes for the compact pieces. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Be3 2. O-O Qd2 3. Ng4 Bf4 4. c5 dxc5 5. dxc5 h3 (+0.64 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: The break can leave d5 weak or meet d5 with less space.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 10-12

10. C5 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: e6. Purpose: Attack d4 and create queenside files before White fixes the center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. e5 d5 4. Na6 Qd2 5. Ng4 Bxg4 (+0.56 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: White can close with d5 and gain space.

11. F5 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: e6. Purpose: Challenge e4 and create kingside activity after securing the king. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Nf3 2. O-O Bd3 3. c5 dxc5 4. dxc5 h3 (+0.69 for White (White is slightly better)). Warning: Opening the f-file can expose Black as easily as White.

12. B5 BREAK COMPASS

Course move: Ne7. Purpose: Gain queenside space and prepare b4 against a stable center. Engine comparison: 1. Nf6 Be2 2. O-O Be3 3. b6 e5 4. dxe5 Nxe5 5. Nfd7 Bf3 (+0.88 for White (White is clearly better)). Warning: A central opening can make wing expansion irrelevant.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.